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ARTICLE VI.

JUDICIARY DEPARTMENT.

1. There shall be a Supreme Court of Appeals, District Courts and Circuit Courts. The jurisdiction of these tribunals, and of the Judges thereof, except so far as the same is conferred by this constitution, shall be regulated by law.

JUDICIAL DIVISIONS,

2. The state shall be divided into twenty-one judicial circuits, ten districts and five sections.

I. The counties of Princess Anne, Norfolk, Nansemond, Isle of Wight, Southampton, Greensville, Surry and Sussex, and the city of Norfolk, shall constitute the first circuit.

II. The counties of Prince George, Dinwiddie, Brunswick, Mecklenburg, Lunenburg, Nottoway, Amelia, Chesterfield, Powhatan and the city of Petersburg shall constitute the second circuit.

III. The counties of Cumberland, Buckingham, Appomattox, Campbell, Prince Edward, Charlotte, Halifax and the town of Lynchburg shall constitute the third circuit.

IV. The counties of Pittsylvania, Bedford, Franklin, Patrick and Henry shall constitute the fourth circuit.

V. The counties of Accomack and Northampton shall constitute the fifth circuit.

VI. the counties of Elizabeth City, Warwick, York, Gloucester, Mathews, Middlesex, Henrico, New Kent, Charles City, James City, and the city of Williamsburg, shall constitute the sixth circuit.

VII. The city of Richmond shall be the seventh circuit.

VIII. The counties of Lancaster, Northumberland, Richmond, West-

rors ; but appropriations for that purpose shall not be made from the State Treasury, except in prosecutions for felony and misdemeanor.

22. At every election of a Governor, an Attorney General shall be elected by the voters of the commonwealth for the term of four years. He shall be commissioned by the Governor, shall perform such duties and receive such compensation as may be prescribed by law, and be removable in the manner prescribed for the removal of Judges.

23. Judges and all other officers, whether elected or appointed, shall continue to discharge the duties of their respective offices after their terms of service have expired, until their successors are qualified.

24. Writs shall run in the name of the commonwealth of Virginia, and be attested by the clerks of the several courts. Indictments shall conclude, against the peace and dignity of the commonwealth.

COUNTY COURTS.

25. There shall be in each county of the commonwealth a County Court, which shall be held monthly, by not less than three nor more than five Justices, except when the law shall require the presence of a greater number.

26. The jurisdiction of the said court shall be the same as that of the existing County Courts, except so far as it is modified by this constitution, or may be changed by law.

27. Each county shall be laid off into districts, as nearly equal as may be in territory and population. In each district there shall be elected, by the voters thereof, four Justices of the Peace, who shall be commissioned by the Governor, reside in their respective districts, and hold their offices for the term of four years. The Justices so elected shall choose one of their own body, who shall be the presiding Justice of the County Court, and whose duty it shall be to attend each term of said court. The other Justices shall be classified by law for the performance of their duties in court.

28. The Justices shall receive for their services in court a *per diem* compensation, to be ascertained by law, and paid out of the county treasury ; and shall not receive any fee or emolument for other judicial services.

29. The power and jurisdiction of Justices of the Peace within their respective counties shall be prescribed by law.

COUNTY OFFICERS.

30. The voters of each county shall elect a Clerk of the County Court, a Surveyor, an Attorney for the Commonwealth, a Sheriff, and so many Commissioners of the Revenue as may be authorised by law, who shall hold their respective offices as follows: The Clerk and the Surveyor for the term of six years ; the Attorney for the term of four years ; the Sheriff and the Commissioners for the term of two years. Constables and Overseers of the Poor shall be elected by the voters, as may be prescribed by law.

31. The officers mentioned in the preceding section, except the Attorneys, shall reside in the counties or districts for which they were respectively elected. No person elected for two successive terms to the office of Sheriff, shall be re-eligible to the same office for the next succeeding term ; nor shall he, during his term of service, or within one year thereafter, be eligible to any political office.

32. The Justices of the Peace, Sheriffs, Attorneys for the Commonwealth, Clerks of the Circuit and County Courts, and all other county officers, shall be subject to indictment for malfeasance, misfeasance, or neglect of official duty ; and upon conviction thereof, their offices shall become vacant.

CORPORATION COURTS AND OFFICERS.

33. The General Assembly may vest such jurisdiction as shall be deemed